CHEMISTRY & BIOCHEMISTRY

Notable Faculty & Student Achievements

March 2026

Violin and chemistry double major **Seth Sagen** '26 was selected to perform violin with the Austin Symphony in their recent Masterworks concerts. He performed Strauss' "Also Sprach Zarathustra," a masterpiece of classical music which is also featured in the beginning of the film *2001: A Space Odyssey*. He shared the stage with his teacher, Assistant Professor of Violin, Viola, and Chamber Music **Jessica Mathaes**, who is concertmaster of the Austin Symphony and performed the concertmaster solos in the piece.

November 2025

Chemistry and biochemistry majors **Kaiden Salaz** '26, **Alex Dow** '26, **Ian Becher** '26, **Saki'a Rivers** '26, **Maddie Bridges** '26, and **Kayla Moody** '26 presented posters and Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey** gave an invited talk at the American Chemical Society Southeast/Southwest Regional Meeting in Orlando, FL in October. Student presentations resulted from research done with Massey, Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer**, and Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Chelsea Massaro**, who also attended the conference.

Professor of Chemistry and Biochemistry and holder of the Garey Endowed Chair in Chemistry **Maha Zewail-Foote** presented at the UNESCO Regional Centre for Quality in Education's International Forum on World Quality Day. Her presentation, "Thinking Differently about Quality: Curiosity, Connection, and the Future of Learning," explored how mentorship, inclusivity, and human-centered teaching can advance educational quality and innovation. Addressing an international audience of education leaders and policymakers, Dr. Zewail-Foote reflected on the power of curiosity and compassion in shaping the future of global education and advancing equitable, high-quality learning experiences.

October 2025

Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer** and Southwestern graduates **Mattigan Aga** '25 and **Holly Lawson** '23 published a research article titled "Plant maturity differentially affects the phenolic composition and antioxidant properties of green basil (Ocimum basilicum L.) cultivars." The article is part of a special issue that highlights undergraduate research in the American Chemical Society's journal *ACS Omega*. The work was supported by The Welch Foundation and Southwestern's Herbert and Kate Dishman endowment. The open-access article is available to read here.

September 2025

Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey** was awarded a Launching Early-Career Academic Pathways in the Mathematical and Physical Sciences (LEAPS-MPS) grant from the National Science Foundation (NSF). This $250,000 research grant will support her lab's research over the next two years, studying the effects of native environment and external stressors on diatom light-harvesting.

Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer** and Southwestern graduates **Haley White** '20, **Bailey Meyer** '20, **Jared McCormack** '22, and **Holly Lawson** '23 published a research article titled "Comparison of culinary and ceremonial matcha green teas: relationship between phytochemical composition and antioxidant properties" in the *Journal of Food Measurement and Characterization*. The research was supported by The Welch Foundation and Southwestern's Herbert and Kate Dishman endowment. The open access article is available to read here.

April 2025

Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey** gave a talk at the American Chemical Society Spring 2025 national meeting in San Diego on her recently published work with

Chemistry majors **Jodi Glenn-Millhouse** '25, **Kaiden Salaz** '25, **Annalina Slover** '26, and **Carolyn Waldie** '26 presented posters on their research on how photosynthetic diatoms adapt their light-harvesting under light and magnesium stress at the American Chemical Society Spring 2025 national meeting in San Diego. Their presentations resulted from research done with Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey**.

March 2025

Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey** and chemistry graduate **Lexi Fantz** '21 published an article titled "Functional Connectivity of Red Chlorophylls in Cyanobacterial Photosystem I Revealed by Fluence-Dependent Transient Absorption" in the *Journal of Physical Chemistry B*. They used ultrafast laser spectroscopy to show energy transfer between low energy chlorophyll sites on the picosecond timescale. This work was done in collaboration with researchers at Swarthmore College, National Institutes of Health, the University of Chicago, and the University of Sheffield. The article can be read here.

DNA structures results in aberrant mutagenic processing," is the result of years of dedicated work and marks a major scholarly milestone. Conducted in collaboration with a research team at UT Austin, this work demonstrates that certain DNA structures are particularly susceptible to damage, contributing to genetic instability — a key factor in diseases like cancer.

November 2024

Ashlyn Cadena '27, **Olive Forrest** '26, **Andres Garza** '27, **Amanda Mejia** '27, **Olivia Johnson** '26, and Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer** attended the 2024 National Science Foundation (NSF) S-STEM Scholars and Principal Investigator Meeting in Chicago, IL. In addition to interacting with other S-STEM Scholars from around the country and attending workshops and professional development sessions, three Scholars presented their research in conference sessions. Garza's poster, titled "Laser induced synthesis of cobalt oxide oxygen evolution catalysts," described work he completed during a summer Research Experience for Undergraduates (REU) program at Texas State University. Mejia presented a poster, "Granular hydrogel synthesis for comparable in vitro model of brain parenchyma tissue," which is based on her ongoing research with Assistant Professor of Physics **Cody Crosby**. Cadena's poster, "Perimeter Minimizing Rectangles in R2 with density M|x| + N|y|," described her collaborative research with other Southwestern math students, Associate Professor of Mathematics **John Ross**, and Adjunct Professor of Mathematics **Lauren Ross**.

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presentation for a special session on mechanisms of genomic repair and mutagenesis at the Southwest Regional Meeting of the American Chemical Society in Waco, TX. Her presentation highlighted research conducted during her sabbatical, in collaboration with researchers at UT Austin.

October 2024

Jodi Glenn-Millhouse ’25, **Kaiden Salaz** ’26, **Annalina Slover** ’26, and **Carolyn Waldie** ’26 presented posters on their research on how photosynthetic diatoms adapt their light-harvesting under light and magnesium stress at the Southwest Regional Meeting of the American Chemical Society in Waco, TX. Their presentations resulted from research done with Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey**.

Biochemistry major **Samantha (Sam) Hazen** ’26 has been selected as a finalist for the American Chemical Society (ACS) Agricultural and Food Chemistry Division (AGFD) Undergraduate Poster Competition. As part of the award, Sam will receive $1,000 in travel expenses to attend the spring ACS National Meeting in San Diego, CA, where she will present her poster, titled “Comparison of phenolic composition, flavonoid content, and antioxidant properties among cacao nibs sourced from different origins.” The poster is based on research that Sam is completing with Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer**. The ACS AGFD competition was created to showcase the research talents of undergraduate students, and all finalists participate in a poster symposium with the possibility of winning

Chemistry major **Jodi Glenn-Millhouse** '25 gave a talk titled "Investigating the Effects of Decreased Magnesium Concentrations on Phaeodactylum tricornutum F710 Fluorescence" at the Fall Undergraduate Research Symposium (FURS) at the University of Texas at Austin on October 5. She was awarded the Best Presentation Award in Chemistry. Her talk resulted from research done with Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey**.

August 2024

Director of General Chemistry Labs **Dilani Koswatta** and Director of Organic Chemistry Labs **Carmen Velez** presented a poster on their collaborative project titled "Fostering STEM Interest Through Chemistry Connections with the Community" at the 2024 Biennial Conference on Chemical Education, held on July 29 at the University of Kentucky in Lexington, KY. This community-engaged learning (CEL) project connected chemistry and biochemistry senior capstone students, general chemistry lab students, and 5th graders from Georgetown's Annie Purl Elementary in an outreach activity designed to spark curiosity about chemistry in young students.

Kentucky in Lexington, KY. The workshop focused on community-based learning (CBL), an educational approach that connects students with community partners to enhance academic learning, civic engagement, and empathy. Participants explored best practices using the Chemistry for the Community (CFTC) curriculum, reviewed examples of CBL implementation, and developed personalized CBL plans by mapping community assets and defining student outcomes.

June 2024

Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey** gave a talk titled "Fluence-dependent transient absorption reveals the functional connectivity of red chlorophyll sites in cyanobacterial PSI" at the North American Photosynthesis Congress, held June 3-6 in Atlanta, GA. She conducted the research with **Lexi Fantz** '21 along with collaborators from Swarthmore College, the University of Chicago, and the University of Sheffield.

April 2024

Garey Chair and Professor of Chemistry & Biochemistry **Maha Zewail-Foote** co-authored a paper in a top journal, *Briefings in Bioinformatics.* She and her co-authors showed that DNA

From a pool of more than 5,000 applicants, biochemistry/mathematics junior and Dixon Scholar **Brian Armijo** ’25 was selected as a 2024 Goldwater scholar - SU’s first ever! The Goldwater Scholarship Program, one of the oldest and most prestigious national scholarships in the natural sciences, engineering, and mathematics in the United States, seeks to identify, encourage, and financially support college sophomores and juniors who show exceptional promise of becoming this nation’s next generation of research leaders in these fields.

Professor of Biochemistry and Garey Chair of Chemistry **Maha Zewail-Foote** presented “Biological and molecular consequences of oxidative damage on non-B DNA-induced genetic instability” at the 2024 American Society of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology National Meeting.

Professor of Biochemistry and Garey Chair of Chemistry **Maha Zewail-Foote** delivered a presentation on effective strategies for improving diversity, inclusion, and belonging within undergraduate research laboratories at the 2024 American Society of Biochemistry and

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Professor of Biochemistry and Garey Chair of Chemistry **Maha Zewail-Foote** co-organized and led a well-attended 90-min workshop titled “Unlocking Your Career Success Through Networking and Mentorship” at the 2024 American Society of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology National Meeting. Workshops were selected based on proposal submissions.

February 2024

an article in the Journal of Chemical Education that describes the adaptation of gelatin methacryoyl (GelMA) hydrogels to the undergraduate laboratory. The authors found that their methods reinforced chemistry laboratory skills introduced students to a new discipline (biomaterials), and increased student interest in the medicinal applications of materials. The article was additionally featured by ACS as a supplementary journal cover designed by Lauren Muskara, a Southwestern alumnus.

November 2023

Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer**, Bailey Meyer ’20, Haley White ’20, and Jared McCormack ’22 published an article titled “Catechin composition, phenolic content, and antioxidant properties of commercially-available bagged, gunpowder, and matcha green teas” in the Springer Nature journal Plant Foods for Human Nutrition. Interestingly, results showed that the lowest-cost teas in the study (such as a loose-leaf gunpowder tea made by Pure Leaf and bagged green teas produced by Allegro, Twinings, and Lipton) had significantly higher phenolic contents and antioxidant capacities than more expensive matcha green teas. The research was supported by the Robert A. Welch Foundation and Southwestern’s Herbert and Kate Dishman endowment. The article is available here.

Meghana Nittala ’24 and Sanjana Nittala ’24 each gave an oral presentation on their research on how photosynthetic diatoms adapt their light-harvesting under light and iron

Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey**.

October 2023

Sanjana Nittala '24 gave a talk titled "The Emergence of the F710 State Due to Iron Stress on Diatom P. tricornutum Light-harvesting Complexes" at the Fall Undergraduate Research Symposium (FURS) at UT-Austin in September. She was awarded the Best Presentation Award in Chemistry. Her talk resulted from research done with Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey**.

August 2023

Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey** presented a poster titled “The light-harvesting response of the diatom P. tricornutum to external stressors varies by native environment” at the Photosynthesis Gordon Research Conference, held July 23-28 in Newry, Maine. She conducted the research with Yusuf Buhari ’23, Sanjana Nittala ’24, Meghana Nittala ’24, and Noor Nazeer ’24.

Former Associate Professor of Chemistry and Biochemistry **Mike Gesinski** and five of his research students—Richard Rodriguez ’23, Natalie Zequeira ’24, Sophia Karim ’24, Luca Cipleu ’25, and Zachary Logan ’26—attended the 48th National Organic Chemistry Symposium, held July 9-13 at Notre Dame University. They met with scientific leaders from academia and the pharmaceutical industry and sang karaoke with Nobel laureates. Together, they presented three posters on the “Titanium-Mediated Synthesis of Cyclobutanones” and the “Gold(I)-Catalyzed Synthesis of Heterocycles.”

The following individuals were recently recognized as award recipients for the 2022-23 academic year. Teaching awards: Visiting Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Chelsea Massaro**, Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Jorge Lizarzaburu**, and Associate Professor of French **Francis Mathieu**. Assistant Professor of Art **Ron Geibel** won the Jesse E. Purdy Excellence in Scholarly and Creative Works Award. The Advising Award went to Associate Professor of Chemistry **Michael Gesinski**.

April 2023

Southwestern University was well represented at the American Chemical Society Spring 2023 meeting in Indianapolis, IN. Five students presented a total of three posters at the meeting: Yusuf Buhari '23, Holly Lawson '23, Sanjana Nittala '24, Meghana Nittala '24, and Noor Nazeer '24. This work was done collaboratively with Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey** and Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer**.

Professor of Biochemistry and Garey Chair of Chemistry **Maha Zewail-Foote** and Associate Professor of Biology **Martín Gonzalez** published an article in the Journal of Chemical Education where they describe the development and implementation of a unique undergraduate research-based laboratory course that cultivates an inclusive and supportive learning community and helps students develop a sense of belonging through mentorship swapped research projects to establish reciprocal peer learning partnerships allowing students to be both learners and teachers.

Several student members of the Texas Alpha chapter of the Alpha Chi Honor Society attended the Alpha Chi National Convention in Albuquerque, New Mexico, where they presented research and creative works from several fields. Arden Neff '25 presented a research poster titled "Using Linear Programming to Optimize Grape Harvest Timing and Yield" based on research supervised by Professor of Computer Science Dr. Barbara Anthony. Chelsey Southwell '24 Samuel Dawson '23 gave a presentation titled "Gold(I) Catalyzed Synthesis of Isoquinolines" based on research supervised by Associate Professor of Chemistry and Biochemistry **Mike Gesinski**. Finally, Anna Wicker '24 gave a piano performance of "Souvenir de Porto Rico" by L.M. Gottschalk, which she selected with the guidance of Professor of Music **Kiyoshi Tamagawa**. Additionally, it was announced that Marcelo Salazar-Barragan '23 was awarded a $3,000 H. Y. Benedict Fellowship. Alpha Chi is a national honor society open to students of all academic disciplines and was founded at Southwestern University in 1922. Only the top 10% of juniors and seniors are invited to join, and our chapter currently consists of 55 student members.

Professor of Biochemistry and Garey Chair of Chemistry **Maha Zewail-Foote** gave an oral presentation at the 2023 American Chemical Society national meeting in the Division of Biological Chemistry's session on Emerging Areas and New Methods in Biological Chemistry. Her talk was titled "Impact of oxidative damage on H-DNA-induced genetic instability."

Professor of Biochemistry and Garey Chair of Chemistry **Maha Zewail-Foote** gave an oral presentation at the 2023 American Chemical Society national meeting, Division of Chemical Education. Her talk was on developing and implementing an undergraduate research-based laboratory course that promotes inclusion and belonging through mentorship and peer-to-peer learning. Her abstract was chosen for the SCI-MIX poster presentation – a poster event representing each division's best.

March 2023

Professor of Biochemistry and Garey Chair of Chemistry **Maha Zewail-Foote,** Cargill Endowed Associate Professor of Education **Alicia Moore**, and Professor of Political Science **Alisa Gaunder** co-presented a virtual session for the Association for American Colleges and Universities (AAC&U) 2023 Conference on Diversity, Equity and Student Success. The mission of the AAC&U conference was to explore the complexities of truth within higher education while examining institutional structures and beliefs that impede diversity, equity, and inclusion goals. The presentation, titled "Cross-Institutional CONNECTions: Mentorship, Truth, Belonging, and Retention," provided an overview of Southwestern's ACS-funded FOC CONNECT project, which seeks to dismantle barriers to success experienced by early-career faculty of color (FOC) in the academy. The project supports a cross-institutional faculty mentoring program that connects these scholars with senior faculty of color from other ACS institutions.

August 2022

Associate Professor of Education **Alicia Moore** and Professor of Chemistry and Biochemistry **Maha Zewail-Foote** were awarded a grant from the Associated Colleges of the South (ACS) to create a unique virtual cross-institutional faculty mentoring program for early-career faculty of color (FOC) called FOC CONNECT. The program will connect early-career faculty of color with senior faculty from other ACS institutions. Through this program, early-career faculty of color will receive mentorship and support. The program will also provide training for selected senior faculty mentors.

Director of Organic Chemistry Labs **Carmen Velez** and Director of General Chemistry Labs **Dilani Koswatta** attended the 2022 Biennial Conference on Chemical Education, held July 31–August 4 at Purdue University in West Lafayette, Indiana. Velez presented her research titled "Culturally Relevant and Socially Responsible Design of Organic Chemistry Laboratory Curriculum."

July 2022

held June 26–30 in San Diego, California. They met with scientific leaders from academia and the pharmaceutical industry, including three Nobel laureates, and presented three posters. Nguyen was awarded best poster for her presentation titled “Titanium-Mediated Synthesis of Cyclobutanones.”

April 2022

Southwestern University was well represented at the American Chemical Society Spring 2022 meeting in San Diego, California. Eight students presented a total of six posters at the meeting: **Yusuf Buhari** ’23, **Sean Calvert** ’22, **Gabrielle Cano** ’22, **Natalie Gierat** ’22, **Rhoda Hijazi** ’22, **Jared McCormack** ’22, **Neha Momin** ’22, and **Ethan Shilgalis** ’22. This work was done collaboratively with Associate Professor of Chemistry **Mike Gesinski**, Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey**, and Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer**.

Feburary 2022

Associate Professor of Chemistry **Mike Gesinski** was awarded a grant from Organic Syntheses Inc. for summer research at a principally undergraduate institution. This award is

Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer** published a chapter titled "Semester-long Projects in the Analytical Chemistry Laboratory Curriculum" in a new edited volume, *Active Learning in the Analytical Chemistry Curriculum*. The book was published by the American Chemical Society (ACS) as part of the ACS Symposium Series. The peer-reviewed pedagogical chapter discusses the implementation and assessment of semester-long projects in undergraduate analytical chemistry lab courses. The chapter was coauthored with Angela González-Mederos of the Inter American University of Puerto Rico–San Germán and Tom Wenzel of Bates College and stems from the group's collaboration during national active-learning workshops for analytical chemistry faculty.

Antioxidant properties" in Elsevier's *NFS Journal*. The peer-reviewed article discusses a collaborative project that involved growing 22 basil varieties from seed (~100 plants), harvesting the basil leaves, and analyzing their chemical composition. The research was supported by the Robert A. Welch Foundation and Southwestern's Herbert and Kate Dishman endowment.

December 2021

Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey** coauthored an article titled "Redox Conditions Correlated with Vibronic Coupling Modulate Quantum Beats in Photosynthetic Pigment-Protein Complexes" that was published in the journal *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America*. The paper was coauthored with scientists at the University of Chicago and Washington University in St. Louis.

October 2021

Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer** and Associate Professor of Chemistry **Mike Gesinski** published a chapter in the book *Equity and Inclusion in Higher Education: Strategies for Teaching* (University of Cincinnati Press, 2021). In their chapter, titled "Active changes have had on improving retention of students from underrepresented groups in STEM fields. More information about the book can be found on the University of Cincinnati Libraries website .

May 2021

Chemistry major **Ethan Iverson** '21 presented his research project titled "Synthesis and Characterization of Three Schiff Base Constitutional Isomers and Their Respective Copper (II) Complexes" at the Spring 2021 American Chemical Society Virtual Convention. The poster presentation resulted from research that Iverson completed with Director of General Chemistry Labs Willis Weigand. Iverson was also awarded the Outstanding Senior Award by the American Chemical Society, which was presented at a virtual awards ceremony by the local Central Texas chapter.

April 2021

Ethan Iverson '21, a research student of Director of General Chemistry Labs **Willis Weigand** , has been invited to present his poster, "Synthesis and Characterization of Three Schiff Base Constitutional Isomers and Their Respective Copper (II) Complexes," at the

March 2021

Sean Calvert '22, in collaboration with Associate Professor of Chemistry and Biochemistry **Mike Gesinski**, received the prestigious American Chemical Society Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship (SURF). As a fellow, Calvert will receive funding to study gold catalysis over the summer under Gesinski's mentorship. Additionally, Calvert has been invited to attend an awards ceremony, present his research at a poster session, and tour Pfizer Research and Development Labs in Groton, CT.

Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Sara Massey** coauthored an article titled "Photosynthesis Tunes Quantum-Mechanical Mixing of Electronic and Vibrational States to Steer Exciton Energy Transfer" in the journal *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America*. The peer-reviewed paper shows evidence that photosynthetic bacteria use quantum-mechanical mechanisms to protect themselves from oxidative damage. The paper was coauthored with scientists at the University of Chicago and Washington University in St. Louis.

January 2021

Professor of Chemistry and the Herbert and Kate Dishman Chair in Science **Emily Niemeyer** published an article titled “Hands-on Experiences for Remotely Taught Analytical Chemistry Laboratories” in the journal *Analytical and Bioanalytical Chemistry*. The article is a contribution to the “ABCs of Education and Professional Development in Analytical Science” portion of the journal and is part of a series on teaching analytical chemistry during the pandemic. Coauthored with Joel Destino and Erin Gross from Creighton University and Steven Petrovic from Southern Oregon University, the peer-reviewed pedagogical article provides an overview of different methodologies that provide hands-on laboratory experiences to students in remote and hybrid analytical chemistry courses. The collaborative article stemmed from Niemeyer’s role as a facilitator at regional and national active-learning workshops for analytical chemistry faculty. Find the article here.

December 2020

approaches to enhance science literacy and model authentic science inquiry in biochemistry. This same learning framework was used when the class quickly shifted to learning about the biochemistry of SARS-CoV-2 last spring.

October 2020

Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer** published an article titled "Instituting a Group Component to a Final Exam" in *Analytical and Bioanalytical Chemistry.* The article is a contribution to the "ABCs of Education and Professional Development in Analytical Science" portion of the journal and was coauthored with Tom Wenzel from Bates College. The peer-reviewed pedagogical article provides an overview of considerations for adding a collaborative group element to final exams in upper-level analytical chemistry courses. The work stemmed from Niemeyer and Wenzel's ongoing collaboration as facilitators at regional and national active-learning workshops for analytical chemistry faculty.

Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer** and **Derrica McDowell** '20 published a chapter titled "Factors Influencing the Production of Phenolic Compounds within Basil (*Ocimum basilicum L.*)" in the forthcoming book *Ocimum: An Overview.* Their chapter discusses the phenolic compounds found within basil and their associated health benefits, explains various strategies to increase phytochemical levels in basil, and offers conclusions about methods that can be used to maximize basil phenolic content. The book is part of the *Herbs*

August 2020

Garey Chair and Professor of Chemistry **Maha Zewail-Foote** published an article in the *Journal of Chemical Education* on transitioning her biochemistry lab class to a remote format. She described the assignments she created that maintained the research learning objectives of the course and enhanced research skills as well as the community outreach project, Making a Difference, that she developed for the class.

April 2020

Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer**, **Jiyoun Ahn** '17, and **Andie Alford** '17 published an article titled "Variation in Phenolic Profiles and Antioxidant Properties among Medicinal and Culinary Herbs of the *Lamiaceae*Family" in the most recent issue of the *Journal of Food Measurement and Characterization*. Ahn and Alford grew 23 common and less-well-known *Lamiaceae*plants during the SCOPE summer research program and then analyzed them for their chemistry capstone research. Niemeyer completed the project by conducting mass spectral analysis of the herbs during her spring 2019 sabbatical in collaboration with colleagues at the University of Texas at Austin. The research was supported by the Howard Hughes Medical Institute (HHMI), the Robert A. Welch Foundation, and the Herbert and

March 2020

Professor of Chemistry **Emily Niemeyer** and **Katie McCance** '15 published an article titled "Classroom Observations to Characterize Active Learning within Introductory Undergraduate Science Courses" in the March/April issue of the *Journal of College Science Teaching*. The authors discuss the analysis of observation data to characterize different instructional practices in science classrooms. McCance, a doctoral student in the Department of STEM Education at North Carolina State University, and Niemeyer collaborated on the study with Timothy Weston, a research faculty member at the University of Colorado, Boulder. The research was completed with support from the Howard Hughes Medical Institute (HHMI).

Feburary 2020

Professor of Biology and Chair of the Pre-Med Advisory Committee **Maria Cuevas** was the recipient of the inaugural Advisor of the Year Award conferred by the Texas Association of Advisors for the Health Professions (TAAHP). The award was created to recognize a TAAHP member who has exhibited excellence in health professions advising over the past year. Cuevas added significant resources for students in her first two years as Southwestern's chief faculty pre-health advisor and chair of the Pre-Med Committee, including a robust